COMPTIA SECURITY+ SY0-701 DOMAIN 0 · CYBERSECURITY

Security+ 0.1 · How to Pass Your SY0-701 Security+ Exam

Mestre CyberSec · **Lesson 0.1 — How to Pass Your SY0-701 Security+ Exam** (10:06) · Assistir Vídeo no YouTube ↗ · Treino Interativo: edusouzamarques.github.io/cybersec

Executive Lesson Summary: Formato da prova: até 90 questões em 90 min; múltipla escolha + performance-based (clicar/arrastar cenário); corta em 750/900. Sem negativação — responde todas. Estratégia do Messer: primeiro responde as fáceis, marca as difíceis e volta no final.

💡 Key Exam Highlights & Critical Concepts

- ~1 min por questão — não trava numa só
- Performance-based aparece no começo — não entre em pânico
- Sem pontos negativos: chute educado nas difíceis
- Meta de estudo: 5-6 semanas dedicadas

🎯 Exam Tips & Typical CompTIA Scenarios

- A prova não fala qual versão — as perguntas cobrem os 5 domínios do objectives PDF
- Prática com tempo real é o que separa aprovado de reprovado

🚨 Beyond the Video: Official Exam Concepts, Protocols & Traps (Section 0.1 — How to Pass Your SY0-701 Security+ Exam)

Why is this advanced coverage required for SY0-701?: Video lectures provide foundational concepts, but CompTIA tests practical engineering judgment and requires deep familiarity with the following protocols, acronyms, and operational nuances in this domain:

• Security+ SY0-701 Exam (SY0-701)
CompTIA Security+ exam code for the SY0-701 version; up to 90 questions in 90 minutes, including multiple-choice and performance-based questions.
⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *O código identifica a versão atual; revise os objetivos SY0-701, não versões antigas como SY0-601.*

• Multiple-Choice Question (MCQ)
Standard exam question with several answer choices and one best answer; may include multiple-response formats.
⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Sem negativação: elimine alternativas erradas e responda todas, mesmo as difíceis.*

• Performance-Based Question (PBQ)
Interactive simulation, drag-and-drop, or click scenario question that tests practical application of Security+ skills.
⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Costumam aparecer no começo; se travar, marque e volte depois, pois consomem tempo.*

• Scaled Passing Score (750/900)
CompTIA Security+ uses a scaled score range of 100–900; 750 is the minimum passing score.
⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *A prova corta em 750/900; não há penalidade por erro, então faça chute educado nas difíceis.*

• Time Management (90 Minutes / 90 Questions)
Pacing strategy of approximately one minute per question, while reserving extra time for PBQs.
⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Não trave em uma questão; responda as fáceis, marque as difíceis e volte no final.*

• Flag for Review (Mark)
Exam tool that lets you mark a question to revisit after completing the rest of the exam.
⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Use para PBQs longas ou dúvidas; garanta que nenhuma questão fique em branco.*

• **No Negative Marking (Educated Guess)**

Incorrect answers do not reduce your score, so there is no penalty for guessing.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Responda todas as questões; elimine alternativas e escolha a melhor opção restante.*

• **Exam Objectives (SY0-701 Objectives)**

Official CompTIA blueprint listing domains, subtopics, and acronyms tested on the Security+ SY0-701 exam.

⚠️ ***Exam Trap:*** *Estude pelos objetivos oficiais; meta de 5–6 semanas dedicadas conforme Messer.*

✅ Authentic Practice Questions (10 Real Exam Scenarios)

Scenario-based exam questions. Complete explanations and distractor analysis are provided in the answer key below.

QUESTION 1 · EXAM SCENARIO

A candidate begins the SY0-701 exam and the first item is a drag-and-drop PBQ involving firewall rule ordering. They have 90 minutes to complete up to 90 items. Which strategy best aligns with CompTIA's recommended exam approach?

A) Complete the PBQ fully on first encounter, spending up to 15 minutes to ensure accuracy before moving on

B) Read the PBQ, flag it for review, work through the multiple-choice items first, and return to it with reserved remaining time

C) Skip the PBQ permanently since it appears early and time is more valuable on multiple-choice items

D) Guess the drag-and-drop placements quickly to submit and immediately continue to the multiple-choice section

QUESTION 2 · EXAM SCENARIO

Midway through the SY0-701 exam a candidate encounters a difficult MCQ on cryptographic key exchange and is unsure of the answer. About 45 minutes remain with 30 items left. What is the best action?

A) Leave the item blank to avoid any penalty for an incorrect selection

B) Select the best educated guess, flag the item for review, and continue; return later if time allows

C) Spend as long as required to reason through the item until certainty is reached

D) Close the item and never revisit it since uncertainty indicates a knowledge gap

QUESTION 3 · EXAM SCENARIO

A candidate completes the SY0-701 exam with an approximate raw count of 65 correct out of 90 items and asks how CompTIA determines the result. Which statement correctly describes the scoring outcome?

A) A raw percentage of about 72% is automatically a pass because SY0-701 requires 70%

B) Only the performance-based items contribute to the final result, so the raw MCQ count is irrelevant

C) CompTIA uses a scaled score where 750 out of 900 is the passing threshold, so a raw count alone cannot determine the result

D) Any raw percentage above 50% passes because CompTIA scales scores downward

QUESTION 4 · EXAM SCENARIO

A security analyst preparing for SY0-701 plans their exam-day time budget. The exam allows up to 90 minutes for up to 90 questions and includes both MCQs and PBQs. Which plan is most realistic?

A) Plan roughly one minute per item on average, but reserve extra time for PBQs so MCQs must be answered faster than one minute

B) Plan a strict two minutes per item because PBQs are typically short and MCQs are lengthy

C) Plan thirty seconds per item to finish early and re-answer every question from scratch

D) Plan no fixed budget because CompTIA pauses the timer automatically on PBQs

QUESTION 5 · EXAM SCENARIO

During the SY0-701 exam, a candidate encounters a PBQ that requires dragging several security controls onto components of an enterprise network diagram. Which is the most effective approach?

A) Attempt the PBQ fully on the first encounter, dedicating up to 15 minutes to guarantee correctness

B) Read the PBQ requirements carefully, note them mentally, flag it for review, complete the surrounding MCQs, and return with reserved time to solve it

C) Skip the PBQ permanently since PBQs appear throughout the exam and are not scored

D) Drag items into slots randomly and submit quickly to move past it without losing time

QUESTION 6 · EXAM SCENARIO

With 20 minutes remaining, a SY0-701 candidate still has 25 items and one flagged PBQ. Which action best maximizes scoring opportunity?

A) Answer the remaining MCQs at a brisk pace with best-effort answers, then return to the PBQ with the leftover time

B) Return to the flagged PBQ first and spend the entire remaining 20 minutes on it

C) Leave the PBQ unanswered and submit immediately to avoid confusion

D) Re-read all previously answered items to verify accuracy before touching the remaining items

QUESTION 7 · EXAM SCENARIO

A candidate asks a mentor whether leaving difficult SY0-701 items blank is safer than guessing. What is the correct guidance?

A) Leave items blank because unanswered questions are not penalized and wrong answers reduce the scaled score

B) Always provide a best-effort answer because unanswered items score as incorrect and there is no penalty for guessing

C) Guess only on items where at least two answer choices seem obviously wrong

D) Skip all items that involve calculations since those count as pilot questions

QUESTION 8 · EXAM SCENARIO

Early in the SY0-701 exam a candidate hits an item requiring a multistep subnetting calculation they can solve, but it will take several minutes. What is the best first-pass action?

A) Spend significant time solving it while the scenario details are still fresh in short-term memory

B) Make the best educated guess, flag it for review, continue through other items, and return at the end if time permits

C) Abandon the exam session to reschedule, since early calculations usually set the difficulty curve

D) Skip directly to the PBQs regardless of where they appear because PBQs are worth more points

QUESTION 9 · EXAM SCENARIO

A candidate finishes all SY0-701 items with 15 minutes remaining and no unanswered questions. What is the most productive use of that time?

A) Submit immediately to avoid overthinking and second-guessing correct answers

B) Review the flagged items, confirming no unanswered items exist, and confirm selections before submitting

C) Re-answer every question from scratch to validate initial instincts

D) Use the remaining time to sketch notes about exam content on the provided whiteboard for future study

QUESTION 10 · EXAM SCENARIO

A candidate sees that multiple PBQs may appear during SY0-701 and wants a time-allocation rule. Which allocation best supports a strong overall score?

A) Allocate roughly one-third of the exam time for PBQs and preserve about one minute per MCQ for the remainder

B) Spend equal time on every item regardless of whether it is an MCQ or a PBQ

C) Skip every PBQ because they are scored the same as MCQs but consume more time

D) Complete all PBQs first whenever they appear, regardless of how much time each consumes

ANSWER KEY & COMPREHENSIVE DISTRACTOR EXPLANATIONS

Question 1: Option B — Read the PBQ, flag it for review, work through the multiple-choice items first, and return to it with reserved remaining time

Messer's strategy and CompTIA guidance recommend flagging complex PBQs, answering the faster MCQs first, then returning to PBQs with reserved time. This maximizes points across the exam rather than over-investing early.

Question 2: Option B — Select the best educated guess, flag the item for review, and continue; return later if time allows

SY0-701 has no negative marking, so an educated guess can only help. Flagging preserves the option to revisit while keeping pace with the timer.

Question 3: Option C — CompTIA uses a scaled score where 750 out of 900 is the passing threshold, so a raw count alone cannot determine the result

CompTIA reports scaled scores on a 100-900 scale with 750 required to pass the SY0-701. Raw counts do not map linearly to the scaled score, so you cannot determine pass/fail from a raw tally alone.

Question 4: Option A — Plan roughly one minute per item on average, but reserve extra time for PBQs so MCQs must be answered faster than one minute

About 90 minutes for 90 items averages roughly one minute per question, but PBQs consume more time, so MCQs must be handled faster than one minute on average to preserve time for PBQs.

Question 5: Option B — Read the PBQ requirements carefully, note them mentally, flag it for review, complete the surrounding MCQs, and return with reserved time to solve it

Reading first, flagging, and returning is the recommended Messer strategy: it prevents an early PBQ from consuming disproportionate time and preserves momentum through MCQs. Guessing at drag-and-drop placements risks incorrect matches.

Question 6: Option A — Answer the remaining MCQs at a brisk pace with best-effort answers, then return to the PBQ with the leftover time

Clearing the faster MCQs first ensures more scored responses, and any remaining time can be spent on the higher-effort PBQ. Spending all remaining time on the PBQ risks leaving 25 items unanswered.

Question 7: Option B — Always provide a best-effort answer because unanswered items score as incorrect and there is no penalty for guessing

SY0-701 uses no negative marking: an empty item is scored incorrect, while an educated guess can only add points. Skipping is never advantageous.

Question 8: Option B — Make the best educated guess, flag it for review, continue through other items, and return at the end if time permits

Flagging and moving forward matches the Messer approach: mark difficult questions, keep pace, and return with dedicated time. Burning several minutes early can cascade into unanswered items later.

Question 9: Option B — Review the flagged items, confirming no unanswered items exist, and confirm selections before submitting

Use remaining time to check flagged items for potential corrections and confirm there are no blanks before submitting, in line with the flag-and-return strategy. Re-answering everything risks overwriting correct choices.

Question 10: Option A — Allocate roughly one-third of the exam time for PBQs and preserve about one minute per MCQ for the remainder

PBQs typically take longer than MCQs. Budgeting around one-third of total time for PBQs and about one minute per MCQ keeps the candidate on pace across the full 90-minute window.